Pratik V. Tanikella

919-949-8817
pratiktanikella@gmail.com
github.com/pratiktanikella23
linkedin.com/in/pratik-tanikella

EDUCATION

UNC Charlotte – Charlotte, NC — Expected Graduation: December 2026

- B.S. in Computer Science

TECHNICAL SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Languages:** Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, C, SQL
- **Frameworks:** Spring Boot, Express.js (Node.js), React, Angular, REST APIs, Microservices, JWT Authentication
- **AI/ML:** LangChain, LangGraph, MCP, Agentic AI, RAG, LLM APIs, AWS Bedrock
- **Cloud & Data:** AWS (EC2, ECS, S3, CloudFormation, Bedrock), Docker, CI/CD, MongoDB, SQL
- **Certification:** PCEP – Certified Python Programmer, OpenEDG Python Institute (Mar 2025, ID 8X2N.vyDh.fw1N)

EXPERIENCE

Vanguard – Charlotte, NC
Application Engineer Intern — Jan 2026 – July 2026

- Improved AI retrieval accuracy by 75%+ and response relevance for a multi-agent retirement planning platform by implementing semantic chunking with AWS Bedrock and Amazon ECS
- Delivered Java RESTful microservices for the multi-agent platform within a 10+ engineer Agile team
- Improved deployment reliability and protected sensitive customer data by automating CI/CD pipelines and building PAN/PII validation workflows with engineering teams

Cisco Systems – Raleigh, NC
Software Engineer I Intern — Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Enabled AI-driven analysis of 1M+ customer support records by engineering an agentic AI platform with LangChain and Model Context Protocol
- Improved backend reliability by building Python and Java services with automated QA testing
- Enabled cross-team integration by designing APIs linking backend services with cloud, embedded, and security teams

BrandSymbol – Charlotte, NC
Business Development Intern — Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Supported business development across 200+ client accounts by conducting market research and maintaining CRM data
- Strengthened 10+ client pitches and project kickoffs by delivering market research and driving client engagement
- Advanced sales progression by managing client outreach alongside Account Executives across multiple engagements

PROJECTS

VivahaPlan – Wedding Platform Planner — February 2026

- Delivered a full-stack wedding planning app (TypeScript, React, Node.js, MongoDB) with JWT auth and guest sharing
- Enabled real-time budget tracking and hotel discovery by engineering REST APIs and geolocation search over 75+ hours

AI-Integrated Business Research – DECA ICDC Finalist — April 2025

- Projected 30-40% labor cost reduction with an AI restaurant platform concept combining chatbot ordering and nutrition tools
- Ranked 8th internationally after researching LLM and AI adoption trends across the food service industry

LEADERSHIP & RESEARCH

Collegiate DECA – UNC Charlotte
Founder, President — Feb 2024 – Present

- Grew UNCC's Collegiate DECA chapter to 100+ students as founder, leading operations and organizational growth
- Secured funding, built the website, and led teams to 70% Top 10 placement at the International DECA Competition

CRA UR2PhD Program – UNC Charlotte
Undergraduate Research Scholar — June 2026 – Aug 2026

- Enabled personalized automated feedback in higher education via role-based assessment logic and scoring algorithms
- Built an AI readiness assessment platform using Python, RAG, and LLM APIs under Dr. Sri Yash Tadimalla

HONORS & AWARDS

- Top 10 at International Collegiate DECA Competition (ICDC)
- 1st Place in Internet of Things Arduino Challenge
- Top 10 at Technology Student Association State Competition